



Date:03-Aug -2026

COURSE HANDOUT (PART-II)

In addition to Part-I (General Handout for all courses) appended to the Timetable, this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course No. : **HSS F334**

Course Title : **SRIMAD BHAGAVAD GITA**

Instructor-in-Charge : **PROF. VINAY CHAMOLA**

Instructor(s): PROF. PRATIK NARANG

1. Course Description:

This course introduces students the timeless wisdom spoken by Lord Krishna in the *Bhagavad Gita* and enables them to appreciate and apply those in daily life. Beginning with the fundamentals of the need to understand spirituality, the content includes science of soul, various types of yogic practices, viz., *karma-yoga* (action in God consciousness), *jnana-yoga* (philosophical research for truth), *dhyana-yoga* (meditative practice), *astanga-yoga* (eightfold yoga system) and culminates with *bhakti-yoga* (devotional service to God). Adopting a topical approach, the course also touches upon these subject matters: the most confidential knowledge, three modes of material nature, nature, enjoyer and the consciousness, divine and demoniac qualities, and the perfection of knowledge.

2. Scope and Objective:

Meant for anyone who wants to make his or her life peaceful, blissful and perfect by aligning oneself to the principles set forth in Srimad Bhagavad Gita. The prime objectives of this course are to understand our relationship (*sambhandha*) with God, the process of reviving that relationship (*abhidheya*), and the goal of that process (*prayojana*). In this context, the 5 important subject matter isvara, jiva, prakriti, kala and karma are discussed in detail.

3. Course Learning Objectives

Upon successful completion of the course, students will be able to:

1. Explain the principal philosophical concepts of the *Srimad Bhagavad Gita*, including *isvara*, *jiva*, *prakriti*, *kala*, and *karma*, and the relationship among them.
2. Differentiate and analyse the major paths of yoga—*karma-yoga*, *jnana-yoga*, *dhyana-yoga*, and *bhakti-yoga*—along with their purpose and practical significance.
3. Apply the teachings of the *Bhagavad Gita* to improve time management, stress management, concentration, emotional balance, self-discipline, decision-making, and overall well-being in academic and personal life.



4. Text Books:

- T1: Prabhupada, His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta. Bhagavad Gita As It Is. Mumbai: Bhaktivedanta Book Trust, 2009.
- T2: The Bhagavad Gita. Gorakhpur: Gita Press, 2007.
- R1: Prabhupada, His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta. Isopanishad. Mumbai: Bhaktivedanta Book Trust, 2002.

5. Lecture Plan:

Learning Objective	Lec. #	Topics	References (Chapter # and sloka # indicated)
Introduction to Bhagavad Gita	1-3	What is Bhagavad-gita; the five subject matters of Bhagavad-gita	Class notes and T1: Introduction
	4-6	Setting the scene; infallible Vedic knowledge-four defects, ways of gaining knowledge; <i>sanatana dharma</i>	T1: Introduction R1: Introduction
Dilemma in the material world	7-8	Arjuna's dilemmas and doubts; perplexities of life in this world: birth, death, disease and old age, three-fold miseries; material relationships: temporary, cause misery; the only solution: spiritual relationship	1.26-46, 8.15, 5.22, 7.14, 13.9, 2.6-7, 10.9, 9.33
Bringing life under spiritual guidance	9-10	Absolute necessity of spiritual relationship with a bona fide spiritual master/teacher; qualifications of a spiritual master; check and balance through Guru, sadhu and <i>sastra</i>	2.7-8; 2.56-61; 4.1-3; 4.34-35, 1.43
	11-12	Qualifications of a disciple/student	4.34, 13.8-12, 16.1-3
	13	Ascending knowledge vs. descending knowledge; importance of hearing; process of hearing	2.53, 7.1, 4.3, 4.26, 13.26 R1: Mantra 10
Science of soul (jiva)	14-15	What is soul? Proof of existence of soul, its nature and individuality; the doctrine of 'life comes from life'; activities in knowledge of the science of soul	2.12-30, 7.4, 7.5
	16	Cause of suffering in this world; constitutional position of living entity	7.27, 15.7, 15.10, 15.16-18
God, the Supreme Lord	17-19	Knowing the Supreme personality of Godhead; Understanding both God's material and spiritual energies, and the supreme controller; understanding the position of God, His expansions and living entities	7.4-7.12, 7.13-14, 9.10, 10.8, 15.7, 4.5, 5.29



Learning Objective	Lec. #	Topics	References (Chapter # and sloka # indicated)
God, the Supreme Lord	20	Lord's descent: His love, purpose and mission; <i>Paramatma</i> : our ever well-wishing best friend	4.6-9, 9 th chapter, 10.9-11, 3.23, 15.15, 18.61, 5.29
	21	Inconceivable nature of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, His qualities and pastimes; cultivating spiritual relationship being the only way to understand Him.	9.4-6, 9.11, 10.1-3, 11.54, 18.55, 4.3, 18.65, 9.34, 7.1
	22	Is God personal or impersonal? Three aspects of the Absolute Truth; path of personalism vs. path of impersonalism	14.27, T1: 2.2 purport, 12.1-7, 5.29, 10.2 4.9, 4.3, 2.12, 4.10-11, 9.4-5, 7.7, 7.24
	23	Demigod worship: universal administration; demigods and their relationship with God; right way to approach demigods	3.10-12, 7.20-23, 9.21, 9.25, 10.2
Yoga (Connecting with Supreme Lord)	24-26	What is yoga? Types of yoga – dhyana, karma, jnana, bhakti; limitation of asthanga yoga in kali yuga; gradual and direct method - bhakti yoga; pure devotional service; the topmost yoga system	2.47; 2.48-51; 6.10-14; 6.33-34; 6.47, 8.28, chapter 7-12
Material Nature	27-29	Three modes of material nature: conditioning of the living entity; characteristics of goodness, passion and ignorance; how the modes bind us; free will and destiny; working for God and working for <i>maya</i> ; Supreme Lord is transcendental to modes; liberation from three modes	14.5-25, 17.1-28, 14.26, 9.13, 2.45, 7.12-14, 3.5, 3.27, 3.29, 3.33, 4.13, 4.23, 5.14, 15.2, 18.19-41
Karma and Karma yoga	30-32	Why bad things happen to good people? Law of karma: good <i>karma</i> , bad <i>karma</i> and <i>akarma</i> ; how to become free from <i>karma</i> and rebirth; <i>karma kanda</i> : flowery language of Vedas; <i>karma yoga</i> and its importance; contemporary relevance of karma yoga; <i>sakama</i> and <i>nishkama</i> karma yoga	4.16-18, 2.42-43, 2.48 3 rd and 5 th chapter, 2.22, 6.41, 6.42-44



Learning Objective	Lec. #	Topics	References (Chapter # and sloka # indicated)
Kala	33	Time (<i>kala</i>) and its influence; impact of this understanding on our heart (“ <i>nimita matram bhava savya sachin</i> ”)	11.32, 8.17-19, 13.6-7, 11.33
Universal Form	34	Universal form	11 th chapter
Divine and demoniac natures	35-36	Four types of people who surrender to God; four types of people who don’t surrender to God; difference between transcendental and demoniac qualities; returning to our divine nature	7.15-19, 16.1-24;
Conclusion	37	Qualities which endear one to God; Krishna’s concluding instructions; Arjuna’s understanding and realizations	12.13-20; 18.65-66; 18.73
	38-39	Sanjaya’s realizations; way to be victorious.	18.74-78

6. Evaluation Scheme:

#	Component	Weight	Duration	Date and Time	Remarks
i.	Mid semester exam	35	90 min.	6/10/2026 FN1	CB
ii.	Quiz	15	1 hour	28 th November 2026	OB
iii.	Google Form-based Exercises (3)	5	NA	Three announced exercises will be conducted through Google Forms. The exercises will carry 10 marks in total , distributed as 2 marks (Exercise 1) , 4 marks (Exercise 2) , and 4 marks (Exercise 3) .	OB
iv.	Comprehensive Examination	45	3 hours	05/12/2026 FN	CB



7. Grading Policy:

Award of grades would be guided by the histogram of marks and course average. Course will be for a total of 200 marks. If a student happens to be in the borderline of two grades, the decision on the final grade will be based on his/her regularity in attending classes, participation in discussions and timely submission of assignments

8. Make up policy:

For a foreseen absence in mid-semester test, comprehensive examination or quiz, the make-up request should be made personally to the Instructor-in-Charge, well ahead of the component. Reasons for unanticipated absence that qualify a student to apply for make-up include medical emergencies or personal exigencies only. In such an event, the student should contact the Instructor-in-Charge at the earliest.

9. Chamber Consultation:

Appointment can be sought by email.

Contact details: vinay.chamola@pilani.bits-pilani.ac.in

10. Announcements and Notices:

All announcements related to the course will be made during the class hours. Email intimations may also be sent.

Instructor-in-Charge
HSS F334